

Servant Leadership:

Matthew 8:5-10 (NKJV) *“Now when Jesus had entered Capernaum, a centurion came to Him, pleading with Him, ⁶ saying, ‘Lord, my servant is lying at home paralyzed, dreadfully tormented.’ ⁷ And Jesus said to him, ‘I will come and heal him.’ ⁸ The centurion answered and said, ‘Lord, I am not worthy that You should come under my roof. But only speak a word, and my servant will be healed. ⁹ For I also am a man under authority, having soldiers under me. And I say to this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes; and to another, ‘Come,’ and he comes; and to my servant, ‘Do this,’ and he does it.” ¹⁰ When Jesus heard it, He marveled, and said to those who followed, “Assuredly, I say to you, I have not found such great faith, not even in Israel!”*

In this passage of scripture we have one of the greatest lessons on servant leadership that you will find in the Bible or anywhere else. The centurion is a man of great influence and when

he approached Jesus his request was not for himself but for his servant. “*Now when Jesus had entered Capernaum, a centurion came to Him, pleading with Him, ‘saying, “Lord, my servant is lying at home paralyzed, dreadfully tormented.”*” Servant leadership is always about others it is never about us.

We should ask ourselves the following questions to determine whether our service is really servant leadership: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Are we serving to make ourselves feel good or to benefit someone else?
- Are we serving because we love these people or because God loves them?
- Are we serving to be seen of man or of God?
- Are we serving for a temporal or eternal reward?

Servant leadership is about giving 100%. The centurion placed his life on hold and laid aside

his very important responsibilities to pursue Jesus on behalf of his servant.

The thing that separates serving from servant leadership is whether one is serving with a whole heart or serving with a halfhearted attitude. Half hearted service cannot be defined as servant leadership and what a healthy church must have is a large number of servant leaders.

When I was growing up, my mother would use the following scripture on me to keep me on the straight and narrow path. Numbers 32:23 (NKJV) ***“But if you do not do so, then take note, you have sinned against the LORD; and be sure your sin will find you out.”*** My mother made me believe every sin I committed would be brought out into the open for all to see. She made a miserable sinner out of me.

We all know that no one ever tells his or her entire life’s story and that not all sin gets exposed. All of us have committed sins that we

placed under the blood and they are going to stay right there. Praise God for that!

So what could this scripture possibly mean? When Moses was giving final instructions to the tribes of Israel, the tribes of Reuben and Gad requested special permission to stay on the opposite side of Jordan from the Promised Land. They were cattle farmers and the land was good for raising cattle.

Moses discouraged them from doing so but finally relents with a special provision. They were to cross the Jordan and help the Israelites conquer the land, only then could they return and set up camp. Moses is saying: ***“If you do what I have said in conquering the land then you can do as you have requested, but if you do not do as I have commanded, be sure your sin will find you out.”***

Moses is pointing to the sin of half- heartedness and say’s ***“The sin of half heartedness will find***

*you out.” Did you get that? “***The sin of half heartedness.***” God sees half-heartedness as a sin!*

The sin of half-heartedness cannot be covered for very long on any level. **Half-heartedness always reveals itself: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- In our relationship with God...
- In our educational process...
- In our marriages and families...
- In our work life and careers...
- Especially in our service to God and others...

If we are going to serve in an area we should do so as a 100%’er! What does 100% look like?

- Serve when you feel like it...
- Serve when you don’t feel like it...
- Be where you are supposed to be when you are supposed to be there...

- Serve with a good attitude... (If you serve and then complain, you might as well not have served at all)

Servant leadership always adds value to the team. This kind of leadership does not always add value to the one offering the sacrificial service, but the team is always better because of it.

The centurion put himself out there for the team. This man took a risk to add value to the team:

- He risked his others responsibilities going undone...
- He risked Jesus rejecting his request for help...
- He risked raising the expectation level of the servant with the possibility of no results...

Servant leaders: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Understand the value they add... (They understand they are not the team, they add value to the team)
- Focus on bringing harmony and health to the team...
- Know how to stand up and they know how to stand down...

The centurion understood the value of alignment. ***“Lord, I am not worthy that You should come under my roof. But only speak a word, and my servant will be healed. For I also am a man under authority...”*** The centurion seems to understand three things here that I find to be profound:

1. He understood that it was not the touch of Jesus that was bringing the miracles about it was the word of Jesus.
2. He realized that Jesus was not doing these things on His own, but was doing them as the result of a much higher authority. ***“I also am a man under authority.”***

3. He understood that when a person comes under authority they have the support of those above them.

The centurion valued the power of being in alignment. Think with me about alignment:

- Your car needs alignments periodically...
- If the spine is out of alignment nothing else works right...
- To have a line means someone is in the front and someone is in the back, alignment must occur between those two points...

Servant leaders:

- Stay in alignment...
- Follow protocols...
- Do not over-step...
- Do not under-step...
- Do not side-step...

Jesus recognized the centurion as the servant leader he was, and results followed. The servant was healed! Great results occur when servant leaders commit to follow a visionary leader.

Notice the words of Jesus with regard to the centurion. *“Assuredly, I say to you, I have not found such great faith, not even in Israel!”* We should not overlook the fact that Jesus calls the actions of a servant leader, *“Faith.”*

Alignment releases a greater sense of health, authority and productivity into the overall vision as well as into the life of the servant leader.

Summary:

Servant leadership:

- Is about serving others...
- Requires a 100% effort...
- Is being willing to take a risk...

- Comes under authority to the vision and the visionary...
- Stays in alignment with the vision and visionary...